

LESSON TWO

WORD OF GOD

Making the Bible Your Standard for Life

**To help you decide to make
the Bible your standard for life
and to build conviction about
what the Bible says about
itself.**

What is your standard in life?

Do you believe the Bible is the Word of God? Do you trust it enough to follow it?

Every person lives by a standard. Some follow:

- personal opinion
- culture
- emotions
- traditions

If the Bible is truly the Word of God, then it must become our final authority.

Before we open the Bible

ILLUSTRATION

If you wanted to measure something accurately, you would need a standard like a ruler. Without a standard, everything becomes a guess.

What is the standard of measurement in your life?

Write down what has actually decided right and wrong for you until now.

Facts About the Bible

01 Written by around 40 authors

SOURCE NEEDED

02 Written in three languages: Hebrew, Aramaic, and Greek

03 Written across three continents: Asia, Africa, and Europe

04 Written over a period of about 1,500 years

SOURCE NEEDED

05 Contains hundreds of prophecies fulfilled in Jesus

COUNT CONTESTED

06 No proven contradiction despite its complexity

REWORD

07 More ancient copies than any other historical document

SOURCE NEEDED

All Scripture Is God-Breathed

2 TIMOTHY 3:16–17 NIV

¹⁶ All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for teaching, rebuking, correcting and training in righteousness, ¹⁷ so that the servant of God may be thoroughly equipped for every good work.

Do you believe that all Scripture is from God?

The Bible is useful to teach, correct, rebuke, and train, so that a person may be fully equipped. It is not just for information. It is meant to transform your life.

To accept the Bible as God's Word means:

- allowing it to correct you
- allowing it to change your thinking
- allowing it to guide your decisions

Alive and Active

HEBREWS 4:12–13 NIV

¹² For the word of God is alive and active. Sharper than any double-edged sword, it penetrates even to dividing soul and spirit, joints and marrow; it judges the thoughts and attitudes of the heart. ¹³ Nothing in all creation is hidden from God's sight. Everything is uncovered and laid bare before the eyes of him to whom we must give account.

The Word of God is living and active. It exposes the human heart. The Bible is like a mirror. It reveals:

- motives
- intentions
- hidden attitudes

Sometimes it is uncomfortable, but it is necessary for growth.

**The goal is not just to
read the Bible, but to let
the Bible change you.**

Three things that take away from God's Word

1 · INTERPRETATION 2 PETER 1:19-21

The Bible is meant to be understood as God intended, not adjusted to fit our opinions.

2 · EMOTIONS JOHN 8:31-32

Feelings do not determine truth. You can feel right and still be wrong. Truth comes from God's Word.

Which of the two has had more influence on what you believe, your own reading, or how you felt at the time?

3 · TRADITIONS

MARK 7:1-13

Religious or cultural traditions can override God's Word.

EXAMPLE

Following tradition instead of obeying Scripture.

**If we are not careful, we
may follow what is
familiar instead of what
is true.**

1 TIMOTHY 4:16 NIV

¹⁶ Watch your life and doctrine closely. Persevere in them, because if you do, you will save both yourself and your hearers.

What is more important: life or doctrine?

Both are equally important. You must guard what you believe (doctrine) and how you live (life). Wrong beliefs lead to wrong actions.

The Bereans

ACTS 17:10–11 NIV

¹⁰ As soon as it was night, the believers sent Paul and Silas away to Berea. On arriving there, they went to the Jewish synagogue. ¹¹ Now the Berean Jews were of more noble character than those in Thessalonica, for they received the message with great eagerness and examined the Scriptures every day to see if what Paul said was true.

ACTS 242 SUMMARY

The believers in Berea received Paul's message with great eagerness, and examined the Scriptures every day to see whether what he said was true.

Do not rely only on what others say. Study the Bible for yourself.

Do What It Says

JAMES 1:22–25 NIV

²² Do not merely listen to the word, and so deceive yourselves. Do what it says. ²³ Anyone who listens to the word but does not do what it says is like someone who looks at his face in a mirror ²⁴ and, after looking at himself, goes away and immediately forgets what he looks like. ²⁵ But whoever looks intently into the perfect law that gives freedom, and continues in it—not forgetting what they have heard, but doing it—they will be blessed in what they do.

Listening without applying leads to self-deception. It is not enough to hear, read, or agree. You must obey.

The Word That Judges

JOHN 12:48 NIV

⁴⁸ There is a judge for the one who rejects me and does not accept my words; the very words I have spoken will condemn them at the last day.

KEY TRUTH

You will not be measured against your own reading of Scripture. You will be measured against Scripture.

ASK

**From today, what will
be your standard?**

Answer Honestly

What has been my standard in life?

Do I follow God's Word or my own opinions?

Am I willing to let the Bible correct me?

What is one thing I have believed that I have never checked in Scripture?

CHALLENGE

- 01 Read the Bible daily
- 02 Begin with the Gospel of John
- 03 Apply what you learn
- 04 Make God's Word your standard

PRAYER

God,

Help me to trust Your Word completely.

Teach me to follow Your truth, not my own understanding.

Give me a heart that is willing to obey and be changed.

Amen.

NEXT

Lesson 3

Discipleship

Following Jesus with commitment and obedience